



## Cosmetic Changes in Gums Around Implants: What to Expect

Gray discoloration around implant areas is a common cosmetic issue that can occur after treatments such as All-on-X implants. While it may be noticeable, it is generally harmless and does not indicate any health risks or functional problems.

### What Causes This Discoloration?

- **Material Visibility:** The grayish tint may be caused by the **metallic components of the implants** being slightly visible through the gum tissue, especially in thin gums.
- **Healing Process:** During the healing period after implant placement, the gum tissue may undergo changes, and slight discoloration can occur as the tissue adapts to the implants.
- **Individual Anatomy:** In some cases, your natural gum and bone structure may make the metallic parts of the implant more visible, leading to a grayish look around implant areas.

### Is This a Concern?

No, this discoloration is **cosmetic only** and does not indicate any health risk or functional problem with the implant. There is no cause for concern from a health standpoint, but we understand that it may be cosmetically undesirable.

### Understanding Gum recession

Sometimes this can occur around the implant sites as part of the natural healing process or due to individual gum and bone structure. This may lead to a more noticeable gap between the gums and implants, but it is usually a cosmetic concern rather than a functional one. If gum recession is significant, it may require additional treatment options.

### What Can Be Done?

While the discoloration can be addressed in the future with minor adjustments, it typically resolves or becomes less noticeable over time as the gum tissue continues to adapt. However some amount of discoloration might not go away. If the cosmetic concern persists, we can explore options to improve the appearance. Our clinician will evaluate your specific situation and may explore a range of options to optimize the cosmetic appearance of the implant areas, ensuring that the solutions are tailored to your individual needs and preferences.

*Enhancing the appearance of the implant areas can be customized every few years based on your preferences.* Please feel free to reach out if you have any further questions or would like to discuss potential cosmetic adjustments.



## Consent Form for Cosmetic Modifications to Dental Implants

At OrbisMed Clinics, we prioritize the long-term success and health of your dental implants. In certain restoration treatments, it is sometimes necessary for a portion of the implant to remain slightly exposed. This exposure typically occurs at the back of the mouth and does not pose a medical concern. In fact, leaving these areas exposed ensures the health and longevity of your implant by allowing proper air circulation and making cleaning more effective.

### Important Information About Exposed Implants:

- **Why the Implant Remains Exposed:** In some cases, the implant design and positioning require slight exposure for optimal function and health. Filling these gaps with crown material is not recommended, as the exposed portion is essential for maintaining implant health.
- **Cleaning Requirements:** These exposed areas must be cleaned thoroughly with tools like a water flosser (e.g., Waterpik) to ensure there is no buildup of plaque or food particles.

### Risks of Filling the Exposed Areas:

While some patients express a preference to have these gaps cosmetically filled, it is critical to understand that doing so is strongly discouraged by our clinic for the following reasons:

1. **Increased Risk of Food Impaction:** Filling these gaps creates areas where food particles can become trapped.
2. **Impaired Cleaning:** These areas will become impossible to clean effectively, even with specialized tools.
3. **High Risk of Implant Failure:** Trapped food and bacteria will lead to infection, inflammation, and eventually implant failure. This can also compromise the prosthetic restoration (crowns or bridges).

OrbisMed Clinics strongly advises against filling these exposed areas. This modification compromises the health of the implant and prosthesis, leading to severe risks and complications. We strongly recommend following our professional advice to ensure the longevity and success of your dental restoration.



## Patient Responsibility Acknowledgment

If, despite our professional advice and serious warnings, you choose to proceed with filling the exposed areas with crown material for cosmetic purposes, you are assuming full responsibility for any complications that arise. This includes:

- Implant failure due to infection or inflammation.
- Damage or failure of the prosthesis (crowns or bridges).
- Additional treatment or costs required to address complications.

By signing this document, you acknowledge that:

- You have been informed of the risks and consequences associated with filling the exposed areas.
- You understand that OrbisMed Clinics and its affiliated professionals strongly advise against this modification.
- You accept that the decision to proceed with filling the exposed areas is against medical advice and absolve OrbisMed Clinics of any responsibility for implant or prosthesis failure resulting from this choice.
- You agree that any additional treatments, repairs, or procedures resulting from implant or prosthesis failure due to this modification will be at your own expense.

### Declaration and Agreement:

I, Patient Name, Surname, the undersigned patient, confirm that I have read and understood the above information. I acknowledge that I have been fully informed of the risks and strongly advised not to proceed with filling the exposed implant areas. Despite this advice, I request to proceed with the cosmetic modification and accept full responsibility for any complications or failures that result from this decision.

**Please write in your handwriting: *I affirm that I have read, understood, and accept this document in its entirety*:** \_\_\_\_\_

Patient / Guardian Name: \_\_\_\_\_

Date of Agreement: \_\_\_\_\_

Patient / Guardian Signature: \_\_\_\_\_

Clinic Coordinator: \_\_\_\_\_

Procedure Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Clinic Coordinator Signature: \_\_\_\_\_

Procedure Date: \_\_\_\_\_